

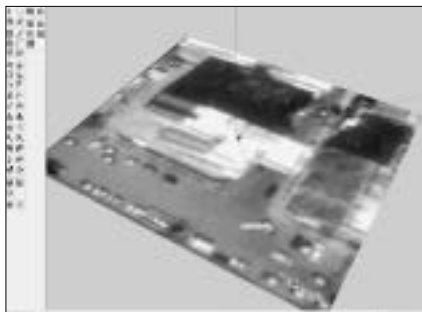


We've set our sights on this apartment building in Mumbai

Now for the first part—selecting a location on Google Earth. We're presuming you know your way around Google Earth—if not, it shouldn't take you more than ten minutes to get a hang of it, anyway. Most people use Google Earth to create models of buildings, so we'll stay with that approach for now.

Even though close-up views on Indian locations aren't as crisp as those in the US, you should fill up your screen with the building you want to model. You should also wait for at least 95 per cent of the image to load, if not 100. Now go over to SketchUp and click on the Get Current View button on the Google toolbar (or **Tools > Google Earth > Get Current View**).

There are several neat things about the way SketchUp gets your view. Firstly, it's accurate—if your building is 100 feet wide in real life, it'll be so in SketchUp—use the tape measure if you don't believe us. Secondly, it stores the geographic information—if you were to centre over the neighbouring building and get that location in SketchUp, it'll create a tile next to the one you created first—you can create the whole neighbourhood this way.



SketchUp imports your current Google Earth view on a tile

Now to start modeling—you can either start with the line tool, trace the outline of the building you want to imitate, or import an existing model you have (**File > Import**) and place it on the Google Earth view.

If your site is on a slope or generally non-level ground, you should